

percent of African Americans were supporting Bernie (as opposed to 82 percent of African American voters supporting Clinton). Protecting marginalized people usually becomes protecting women, but always white women, and protecting the poor, but the white poor.

The most vulnerable—the people who could most benefit from the change Occupy—and later Bernie—promised, didn't have time to go to rallies. They had to work. Then the people who do have the time become the criticism du jour of the right-wingers, who point out that everyone working to dismantle the system is “privileged” and “idealistic” and “entitled” and “naive.” Even I was skeptical of protesting during the time it would have benefited me most and when I had the most time to do it.

When I lived in New York in 2011, I went down to Zuccotti Park, where Occupy was happening, a couple times to check it out, but I wasn't looking to join this group of do-nothings. I still felt that incorrect, nagging voice telling me that financial strife was a personal intellectual and moral failing. I wouldn't be one of those people who blamed the system. I'd pull myself up by my bootstraps, the American way. I told myself I was different from these losers. If I joined these protesters, I'd be admitting defeat. I wanted to believe I was better. (After much research and a successful money podcast, I can now conclude I am not. None of us are.)

But my 2011 thoughts and doubts are how the system wins over and over again. (As Charlie from *It's Always Sunny in Inland* screamed, “THERE IS NO CAROL IN HR!!!!”)

I'm still on the fence about the DSA, especially the holier-than-thou attitude I've seen displayed on social media, but it was nowhere to be heard in my delightful and engaging conversation with Peyton-Carrillo. I also completely understand the strong message and uncompromising opinions of the DSA as a result of the 2016 election. Going hard with open eyes and ears is not a bad option.

“It's time to quit losing, it's time to build something of your own, and this is the way forward to doing that. That's the pitch if I ever had to encounter somebody who was like, ‘Well, I don't have time for it.’ Things that are